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5 WEEKLY IN PRINT AND ONLINE

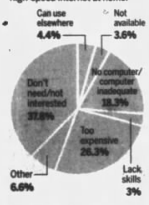
BUSINESS
NUMMI, UAW AWAIT UNION VOTE ON AGREEMENT

SPORTS
MARCH MADNESS WOMEN'S BRACKET

SPORTS
WHY CAN'T NCAA TOURNAMENT TEAMS PLAY CLOSER TO HOME?

Why no broadband?

Main reasons given for not having high-speed Internet at home:



Source: National Telecommunications and Information Administration

MERCURY NEWS

23,000 school jobs in peril

More than 4,100 in Bay Area sent pink slips after Monday's deadline imposed by state

By Theresa Harrington
tharrington@bayarearesearchgroup.com

Education budget cuts have prompted school districts across the state to send out more than 23,000 pink slips, notifying teachers and other certificated employees they may not have jobs next year.

ONLINE: Visit our economic crisis page at InsideBayArea.com/economic-crisis.

In a morning news conference, state Superintendent for Public Instruction Jack O'Connell said 21,905 pink slips had gone out from districts, which had to meet a state-mandated Monday deadline to notify staff they may not have jobs next year.

"While I understand the governor and the Legislature have tough decisions to make, these budget cuts are devastating our schools and impacting our ability to do the most important job in our society, that is, to teach our children," O'Connell said in a statement.

By Monday afternoon, the number of notices had swelled to 23,225, according to figures from the California Teachers Association, which represents 325,000 teachers. Pink slips were sent by 464 school districts statewide, including more than 4,100 in the greater Bay Area, the union said. These do not include notices given to probationary

See LAYOFFS, Page 9

BY THE NUMBERS

An informal sampling of preliminary layoff notices issued by East Bay school districts.

ALAMEDA COUNTY

- **NEWARK UNIFIED:** 68 out of 350 certificated staff.
- **OAKLAND:** As many as 58 notices out of 2,347 teachers.
- **PLEASANTON UNIFIED:** 37 out of 771 certificated staff.
- **NEW HAVEN UNIFIED:** 47 out of 682 certificated staff.

FCC aims to expand access to broadband

Plan looks to improve Internet availability for millions, form network to help emergency workers communicate

By Jim Puzzanghera
Los Angeles Times

WASHINGTON — Culminating a year of extensive outreach and study, federal regulators today will propose an ambitious, decade-long road map to extend high-speed Internet access to every corner of the country and make the United States home to "the fastest and most extensive wireless networks of any nation."

The plan by the Federal Communications Commission sets a goal of assuring that at least 100 million homes have affordable access to broadband networks that allow them to download data from the Internet at speeds of at least 100 megabits per second — 20 times or more faster than most people get today. The proposal, which will be sent to Congress, also seeks to put superfast Internet access of 1 gigabit per second in public facilities such as schools, hospitals and government buildings in every community.

The FCC released the proposal's executive summary Monday.

Another key component of the plan is creating a new wireless network for police, firefighters and other public safety workers

See BROADBAND, Page 9

THE ORIGINAL
GO-DADDY

SHERRY LAVARS/STAFF PHOTOS

Doug Sabiston, of Moraga, drives his 2005 Buick LaCrosse last week during "Wednesday Night Drags" at Infineon Raceway in Sonoma. Sabistion, 89, got his first driver's license in 1936 and is probably the oldest person to race on the Sonoma County track.

Moraga man, 89, pushes his 2005 Buick to the limit

By Jennifer K. Rumple
Correspondent

SONOMA — "The Professor" steps lightly on the gas pedal to ease his 2005 Buick LaCrosse — the family car — to the start line. He anxiously stares at the vertical lights glaring amber through his windshield, waiting for the flash to green.

The veteran racer revs his engine, careful not to let his foot off the brake. If he takes off too early, he's disqualified. If he waits for the green light to floor it, he's too late.

This kind of precise balancing act makes Doug Sabiston nervous, but excited. All the Moraga resident wants is to keep his opponent in his rearview mirror 'til he crosses the finish line a quarter-mile down the drag strip.

The retired statistics instructor has replayed this scene more than 1,000 times over the past 20 years at the Infineon Raceway's Wednesday Night Drags.

At 89, Sabiston's reflexes remain sharp.

"It's always that kind of nervousness wondering if your reaction time is going to be OK — all kinds of things run through my mind when I'm just sitting there focusing on the lights," he explained. "If you get distracted in any way, it can usually be very costly."

See RACING, Page 9

IN MORNING REPORT

GOP HOPEFULS SQUARE OFF

A former eBay executive Meg Whitman, left, and California Insurance Commissioner Steve Poizner greet each other Monday before their debate in Costa Mesa as they battle for the Republican gubernatorial nomination.

JAE C. HONG/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Cold calling for a higher calling

Priest tries to recruit men for clergy in Diocese of Oakland

By Ginny Prior
Correspondent

The Rev. Larry D'Anjou is looking for a few good men.

Not for the Marines, but for the priesthood in the Catholic Church's Diocese of Oakland.

As director of vocations, he's looking for men to sign on for a life of sacrifice, service and celibacy.

D'Anjou

A hard sell? It depends on who's doing the cold-calling.

"The way the church teaches us," D'Anjou says, "it's a call that comes through the sacrament of baptism."

In other words, it's God Himself on the line.

But in too many parishes, the call goes unanswered. Whether it's the high-profile abuse cases that have plagued the church or just society's shifting values, a shortage of priests is forcing uncomfortable changes.

"In a number of places," he says, "It's not that unusual for a priest to cover two or three parishes."

Oakland, perhaps surprisingly, is bucking the odds. Designating D'Anjou as a full-time recruiter has paid off, and the 84 Catholic churches in the diocese have been holding their own with adequate staffing.

"We lose, on average, four or

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